

Complete Shop Workflow

From Vehicle Arrival to Final Payment

Document:	Redlined1-Shop-Workflow
Version:	1.0 June 2026
Audience:	Service Advisors, Technicians, Shop Owners
Steps:	12 steps across 6 phases: Intake ' Job Setup ' Inspection ' Parts ' Repair ' Billing

Phases at a Glance

 INTAKE	Steps 1 2	 JOB SETUP	Steps 3 4
 INSPECTION	Steps 5 6	 ESTIMATE	Step 7
 PARTS	Step 8	 REPAIR	Steps 9 10
 BILLING	Step 11	 PAYMENT	Step 12

01

INTAKE

Customer Arrives / Appointment Check-In

Module: Appointments

- Greet customer and pull up their appointment in the Appointments module
- Verify customer name, contact details, and vehicle
- Click "Check In" on their appointment row to mark arrival
- Confirm the complaint or service requested by the customer

=j Pro Tip: If walk-in, create a new appointment on the spot before checking in.

02

INTAKE

Open or Confirm Customer & Vehicle Record

Module: Customers ' Vehicles

- Go to Customers search for the customer by name or phone
- If new customer, click "+ Add Customer" and fill in name, phone, email
- Open the customer profile and confirm their vehicle is listed
- If new vehicle, click "+ Add Vehicle" enter Year/Make/Model, VIN (17 chars), plate, mileage
- Use VIN Decode (sidebar) to auto-fill vehicle spec from the VIN

=j Pro Tip: Record the odometer reading every visit for accurate mileage history.

03

JOB SETUP

Create a Job Card

Module: Job Cards

- Click "+ New Job Card" (top header or from customer profile)
- Customer and vehicle will pre-fill from context
- Describe the complaint / work requested in the description field
- Assign a technician and set the Promised By date
- Set status to "In Progress" and save
- Share the Status Tracker link with the customer (from job card detail drawer)

=j Pro Tip: The job card is the anchor for every other step inspection, RO, invoice all link back here.

04

JOB SETUP

Share Live Repair Status Tracker with Customer

Module: Job Cards ' Status Tracker

- Open the job card detail drawer and click "Status Tracker"
- Copy the unique customer link and send via SMS or WhatsApp
- Set stage to "Checked In" customer sees this on their link instantly
- As the job progresses, advance stages with optional SMS/email notification

=j Pro Tip: This eliminates "where is my car?" calls. Customers track it themselves.

05

INSPECTION

Run a Digital Vehicle Inspection*Module: Inspections*

- From the job card, click "Inspection" to open a new inspection pre-linked to this job
- Work through the checklist: Brakes, Tyres, Engine, Electrical, Fluids, Body, Lights
- Mark each item: Green (Pass), Yellow (Attention), Red (Fail)
- Attach photos to any Fail or Attention item from your phone camera
- Advance Status Tracker to "Being Inspected"

=j Pro Tip: Photos build trust and protect you from disputes. Take them on every fail item.

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INSPECTION

Send Inspection Report & Get Customer Approval*Module: Inspections ' Share Link*

- Click "Share Link" in the inspection panel copy the customer-facing URL
- Send the link via SMS, WhatsApp, or email to the customer
- Customer opens a branded page showing colour-coded inspection results and photos
- Customer approves or declines each repair item individually
- Customer types their name as a digital signature and submits
- Check the admin panel their exact decisions and signature are recorded permanently

=j Pro Tip: Per-item approval increases authorised work value vs. blanket approve/decline.

07

ESTIMATE

Create an Estimate for Approved Work*Module: Estimates*

- From the inspection, click "Create Estimate" to open a pre-filled estimate
- Add labour lines for each approved repair with hours and rate
- Add parts lines with description and sell price
- Review subtotal, tax, and total adjust if needed
- Send the estimate customer receives a professional PDF with Approve/Decline buttons

=j Pro Tip: Only include items the customer approved on the inspection. Declined items stay off.

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PARTS

Source & Order Required Parts*Module: Parts ' Parts Orders*

- Go to Parts ' Inventory tab check if parts are already in stock
- For in-stock parts, note the bin location and set aside for the job
- For parts to order, go to "Parts Orders" ' "+ New Parts Order"
- Select customer and vehicle from dropdowns, choose vendor, enter cost and deposit
- Set ETR (Expected Time of Receipt) date and Order Status to "Ordered"
- Update job card status to "Waiting for Parts" dashboard flags the job as paused
- When parts arrive, update order status to "Received" and resume the job

=j Pro Tip: Link each parts order to the Job Card # for full traceability.

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REPAIR

Technician Clocks In & Begins Work

Module: Time Tracking + Repair Orders

- Go to Time Tracking ' select the technician ' enter Job Card # ' click "Clock In"
- Active session appears with a live elapsed timer
- Open Repair Orders ' create a new RO linked to this job card
- List each repair task with parts used and labour time
- Advance Status Tracker to "In Repair" customer is notified

=j Pro Tip: Accurate clock-in/out data feeds payroll reporting and labour billing.

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REPAIR

Complete Repairs & Quality Check

Module: Time Tracking ' Job Cards

- Technician clicks "Clock Out" when work is complete
- Service advisor performs a quality check on the finished vehicle
- Advance Status Tracker to "Quality Check"
- Update job card status to "Complete"
- Add any internal notes about work performed (not visible to customer)

=j Pro Tip: Never skip the quality check step it catches mistakes before the customer does.

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BILLING

Create & Send Invoice

Module: Invoicing

- From the job card, click "Create Invoice "" labour and parts pre-fill from the RO
- Review all line items, adjust quantities or prices if needed
- Add tax (auto-applied from your Settings ' Tax rate)
- Set the due date and click "Send" customer receives a branded PDF with a Pay Now link
- Advance Status Tracker to "Ready for Pickup" page turns green for customer

=j Pro Tip: Sending the invoice and the Ready notification at the same time = fewer phone calls.

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PAYMENT

Collect Payment & Close the Job

Module: Payments

- If paying online via the invoice link payment auto-records and invoice marks Paid
- For in-person payment, go to Payments ' "Record Payment"
- Select the customer, amount, payment method (cash, card, Zelle, etc.), and link invoice #
- Save the invoice Balance Due updates to "PAID IN FULL" automatically
- Job card status should be set to "Invoiced" if not already updated automatically
- File digital records every document is saved permanently in the customer profile

=j Pro Tip: For fleet customers, use "Fleet Account / Net 30" as the method and follow up at month-end.

Quick Reference Staff Cheat Sheet

Print this page and post it at the service desk

1 Customer arrives ' Check In on Appointments

2 Confirm Customer + Vehicle record

3 Create Job Card ' assign tech + promised date

4 Send Status Tracker link to customer

5 Run DVI Inspection ' mark + photo every item

6 Send share link ' customer approves per item

7 Create Estimate for approved work only

8 Check stock or create Parts Order with ETR

9 Tech clocks in ' create Repair Order

10 Tech clocks out ' QC check ' job Complete

11 Create Invoice ' send ' Status: Ready

12 Collect payment ' mark invoice Paid ' close

RULE: Never skip a step. Every step creates a record that protects you and your customer.

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